

Phase 7: Project Documentation

User Manual

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Setup & Installation

To run the SmartLender application locally, follow these steps:

1. Ensure Python 3.12+ is installed on your system.
2. Open a terminal and navigate to the directory of the project.
3. Create a virtual environment: `python -m venv .venv`
4. Activate the environment:
 - Windows: `.venv\Scripts\activate`
 - macOS/Linux: `source .venv/bin/activate`
5. Install dependencies: `pip install -r requirements.txt`

Running the Application

Once the setup is complete, start the local web server by executing the following command inside the `Flask/` directory:

- `python app.py`

You will see terminal output indicating the server is running. Open your web browser and navigate to: **`http://127.0.0.1:5000/`**

User Guidelines

1. **Home Page:** Read the project details on the landing page. Click the green “Start Application” button.
2. **Filling the Form:** Fill out all fields on the application form. Select the appropriate options from the dropdowns (e.g., Gender, Education) and enter numerical values for income and loan amounts.
3. **Submission & Output:** Click “Check Loan Status”. The system will process the data instantly and redirect you to the results page.
4. **Understanding Results:** The output page will display either “APPROVED” (in green) or “REJECTED” (in red). It will also show a “Model Confidence” percentage, indicating how certain the AI is regarding its decision. Use the “Back to Home” link to test another application.